

Tamim Al Faiz

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PROFESSIONAL OVERVIEW

Lead Infrastructure Cloud Architecture

Technology Infrastructure Leader with over a decade of experience in architecting, implementing, and managing on-premise, cloud, and OpenShift environments. My career has progressed from Cloud Consultant at IBM to Senior Cloud Architect at Red Hat, and I currently serve as the Lead Cloud Infrastructure Architect at IBM. I bring extensive hands-on experience across the full lifecycle of DevOps and cloud solution delivery, from initial design to production implementation and ongoing administration. I hold a Master's in Computer Science from the Washington, D.C. area.

SKILLS & COMPETENCIES

Professional	Adaptability; Active Listening; Attention to detail; Flexibility; Critical Thinking; Leadership; Multitasking; Problem Solving; Research; Setting Boundaries; Teamwork; Time Management; Written and Verbal Communication
Language	Arabic (Native); English (Fluent)

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Programming Languages	Python, Linux Scripting, HTML, CSS, JavaScript
Tools	LaTeX Editing, MS Visual Studio Coding, VirtualBox Vms Creation, DevOps tools such as ArgoCD, CI/CD Pipeline
Cloud Technologies	IBM Cloud, Oracle Cloud, Red Hat OpenStack Cloud, OpenShift, IBM Cloud Pak Components, AWS Services, Google Services, IBM Watson Services
Database Management	AWS S3 Storage, IBM Cloud Object Storage, IBM Fusion, MySQL, Microsoft Excel
Cloud Security and Monitoring tools	Prisma, Instana, Grafana, Dynatrace, ACS, ACM, Splunk, OKE GPU Oracle

EDUCATION

Master of Science in Computer Science <i>Catholic University of America - CUA</i> GPA: 3.85/4	Jan 2017 - Jan 2019 Washington, D.C., USA
Intensive Language and Culture Program <i>University of Alabama in Huntsville - UAH</i> - MSc Programming languages, C2 English Language	Aug 2016 - May 2017 Huntsville, AL, USA

OPERATIONAL & IMPLEMENTATION PROFICIENCY

Red Hat OpenShift	Design and Implementation of Openshift Infrastructure (3.x, 4.x)
Red Hat ODF	Design and Implementation of Openshift Data Foundation (4.x)
Cluster Management	integration new/existing OCP clusters with ACM
Cloud Security ACS	Managing the scanning for containers, namespaces vulnerability
Ansible & Ansible Tower	Design and Implementation of Ansible & Ansible Tower
Red Hat Satellite	Implementation of Red Hat Satellite
ImageRegistry	Managing containers application images to be hosted on Quay internally offline

EXPERIENCE SUMMARY

IT Infrastructure Operation Management	8 years
IT Project Management (PM)	8 years
IT Services Delivery	8 years
IT Administration	10 years
IT Software programming	10 years
IT Architecture, design, and Implementation	8 years
IT Solution Architecture Demonstrating	8 years

WORK EXPERIENCE

Lead Infrastructure Cloud Architecture	Aug 2023 – Present
<i>IBM KSA - Alrajhi Bank NRR</i>	Riyadh, Saudi Arabia
Description	

Managed and administered OpenShift and Kubernetes infrastructure across on-premise and cloud environments, including architecting, designing, and implementing cloud-native solutions, disaster recovery, and legacy system migrations, while ensuring operational stability and resilience through Day-to-day work involves administering 40+ OpenShift clusters, performing etcd backups, patching infrastructure components, writing health-check scripts, supporting application team deployments, performing health checks for critical workloads, and managing production failover and failback activities.

Senior Cloud Architect	Aug 2021 – Aug 2023
<i>Red Hat - EMEA Customer</i>	Riyadh, Saudi Arabia
Description	

End-to-End OpenShift Solution Delivery: Responsible for the production design and implementation of OpenShift solutions for diverse clients across Saudi Arabia and the EMEA region, encompassing prerequisite preparation, day-1 installations, and day-2 post-configuration activities. Key Delivered Project:

Alinma Bank	Implemented OpenShift on VMware.
STC Telecom	Executed bare-metal OpenShift deployments.
DU Telecom	Deployed OpenShift on OpenStack
Zain Telecom	Integrated Quay registry with CI/CD automation.
Tahakom Technology	Performed upgrades and patching for OpenShift 4.x clusters.
Riyadh Bank	Managed migration and containerization of legacy applications and workloads from OpenStack Cloud to RHV for OpenShift

Cloud Consultant

IBM - EMEA Customer

Aug 2019 – present

Riyadh, Saudi Arabia

Description

Responsible for customer support such as installing and upgrading Cloud Pak for Integration (CP4I) components on OpenShift to enable microservices integration, including IBM DataPower Gateway, IBM Event Streams, IBM API Connect, IBM MQ, and IBM App Connect (ACE), as well as building, training, and testing AI and machine learning models for Arabic chatbots using IBM Watson for clients such as a patient-inquiry chatbot for the Ministry of Health and an STC solutions chatbot. In addition to data science project participation globally with Kaggle involving processing a dataset of 158,000 scholarly articles, extracting full-text content from nested JSON files using Python, preparing 9,120 articles for NLP analysis in IBM Watson Discovery, and training question-answering models to improve scholarly information retrieval — a project featured 

Data Scientist

Deloitte

MAY 2019 – Aug 2019

Riyadh, Saudi Arabia

Description

In this journey I experienced consulting full-time at the Ministry of Communications and Information Technology for the Yesser E-Government Program under Saudi Arabia Vision 2030. I cleaned, filtered, and merged large unstructured datasets using Python, Pandas, NumPy, and Regular Expressions. I analyzed and visualized complex data to extract insights and presented findings to cross-functional teams for strategic decision-making.

WORKSHOPS & TRAINING

Delivered hands-on technical workshops on emerging technologies and development methodologies to upskill developers through knowledge sharing. 

COMMUNITY VOLUNTEER IT PROJECTS

IBM Academy Call for Code Initiative 2020

Developed a COVID-19 Research Assistant Chatbot to extract insights from scientific literature using IBM Watson Discovery AI search engine, integrated with Watson Assistant. Project featured in a Medium blog post. 

IBM Clients Showcase 2020

Designed and developed a COVID-19 Visual Insights Personal Face Mask Detection system using IBM Cloud Annotation and Watson Machine Learning. 

Ministry of Interior - MOI Absher THon - Hackathon Participated 2020

Designed and developed a real-time application to predict vehicle accident rates using computer vision methodologies. 

CONFERENCE & WORKSHOP SESSIONS CHAIRED

1st International Conference on Artificial Intelligence (CAIDA)  <i>IEEE</i>	April 2021 Riyadh, KSA
Explore Artificial Intelligence Use cases <i>Prince Sultan University - PSU (CAIDA)</i> 	April 2021 Riyadh, KSA
Introduction to IBM Cloud <i>King Fahd University of Petroleum and Minerals - KFUPM</i>	March 2020 Riyadh, KSA
Explore IBM Power Artificial Intelligence Vision <i>Saudi Federation for Cyber Security and Programming - SAFCSF</i>	Feb 2020 Riyadh, KSA
Winter Conference Applications of Computer Vision (WACV)  <i>IEEE</i>	Jan 2019 Hawaii, Waikoloa, USA
U.S.-German Standards Panel on Securing Future Technologies  textitANSI	April 2018 Washington, D.C., USA

RESEARCH POSTER PRESENTATIONS

Simulation System for Operational Decision Support in Emergency Unit  <i>Catholic University of America - CUA</i>	April 2018 Washington, D.C., USA
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SKILLS DEVELOPMENT

Certificate Name	Organization	Location	Date	Status
IEEE (CAIDA) Appreciation	IEEE	In person	2020	Certified
IBM Academy of Technology Appreciation	IBM	In person	2020	Certified
Ministry of Interior (AbsherTHon) Appreciation	MOI	In person	2020	Certified
NLP Watson Build Your Own Chatbot	IBM	Virtual	2019	Certified
Call for Code Contributor	IBM	Virtual	2020	Certified
Deep Learning with TensorFlow	Cognitive Class	Virtual	2020	Certified
Machine Learning with Python	Cognitive Class	Virtual	2020	Certified
Accelerating Deep Learning with GPU	Cognitive Class	Virtual	2020	Certified
Cloud Pak for Data Executive	IBM	Virtual	2020	Certified
Oracle Cloud Infrastructure	Oracle	Virtual	2020	Certified
EX280 Red Hat Specialist in OpenShift Administration	Red Hat	Virtual	2021	Certified
EX180 Red Hat Specialist in Containers and Kubernetes	Red Hat	Virtual	2020	Certified
Saudi Architecture and planning Association.	SACM	In person	2018	Certified
Essential Skills for Successful Leaders	SACM	In person	2017	Certified

TERMINOLOGY

Understanding and alignment of common vocabulary is critical to any engagement's success. The following table is a reference guide of acronyms/words/phrases and their definitions/meanings that appear in this document.

Acronym	Word Phrase	Definition Meaning
RHEL		Red Hat Enterprise Linux
RHOCP		Red Hat OpenShift Container Platform
RHCOS		Red Hat Core Operating System
ODF		OpenShift Data Foundation
PV		Persistent Volume (OpenShift concept for providing Storage)
PVC		Persistent Volume Claim (OpenShift concept for providing Storage)
HA		Highly-Available (redundant/failover setup)
RHV		Red Hat Virtualization
UPI		User Provision Infrastructure
IPI		Installer Provisioned Infrastructure
RHACM		Red Hat Advance Cluster Management
RHACS		Red Hat Advance Cluster Security for Kubernetes
CP4I		IBM Cloud Pak for Integration
RHOSP		Red Hat OpenStack Platform
RHCEPH		Red Hat Ceph Storage
RHSSO		Red Hat Single Sign-On